Yingrui Hou

Data Science & Scientific Data Engineering

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https://yingrui-hou.github.io/PersonalPage/

Profile

Physics PhD with postdoctoral experience in statistical modelling, CatBoost workflows and learned-model calibration. Learned TensorFlow through adapting inherited code, verifying models and moving computation to a shared GPU workstation. Enjoys diagnosing problems, testing solutions and advancing collaborative projects; seeks to apply these skills to data applications that help improve people's everyday lives.

Core skills

- Model assessment: deep-learning calibration, image-recognition model validation, real-data performance checks, train/test diagnostics and bias correction.
- Modelling: likelihood and mixture models, statistical inference, uncertainty analysis, CatBoost/gradient boosting, feature selection and distribution reweighting.
- Workflows: inherited-code adaptation, reusable processing, Shell/YAML/CMake, Linux and shared GPU workstation setup/management.
- Programming & computing: Python, NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn, statsmodels; C/C++, ROOT/RooFit; TensorFlow and GPU numerical evaluation.

Research experience

Postdoctoral Researcher | 2021–2026

CNRS — LAPP, Annecy (2021–2023); LPC/LPCA, Clermont-Ferrand (2023.12.01–2026.05.31). Research in LHCb and GRAiNITA collaborations.

- Developed a Shell pipeline for beam-test acquisition, storage, quick calibration and initial quality checks, connecting detector readout, tracking and timing calibration. Participated in on-site setup and data taking; assisted subsequent fitting and measurement-effect corrections.
- Developed CatBoost selection with reweighting, feature pruning, five-fold assessment and train/test KS checks; scanned a measurement-oriented threshold using fitted yields and selection efficiencies.
- Aligned simulated, control and target datasets through gradient-boosting reweighting and calibration; propagated residual modelling differences into uncertainty assessments.
- Diagnosed incorrect ECAL photon truth associations; revised cluster-energy matching, tested multiple simulated decay channels and improved thread safety through review. The merged change supported subsequent Run 3 analyses and reconstruction-performance checks.

Doctoral research training | 2016–2021

University of Chinese Academy of Sciences — joint Master and PhD in Particle Physics. Training in quantitative problem formulation, scientific computation, experimental validation and communication of research results.

Education

- Joint Master and PhD in Particle Physics — University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, 2016–2021.
- BSc in Applied Physics — China University of Mining and Technology, 2010–2014.

Selected project evidence

ECAL diagnosis and integrated software correction

Traced anomalous simulated photon resolution to incorrect truth associations under high occupancy. Revised matching using normalised truth-particle energy deposits within the photon cluster. Checked identities, energies and event histories across several simulated decay channels. Improved thread safety following review; the MR was merged and used in Run 3 analyses and reconstruction-performance checks.

Calibrating learned-model outputs

Selected reference channels, aligned kinematics with gradient-boosting reweighting and fitted predicted-to-observed mistag calibration. Cross-checked with reweighted signal simulation; results agreed within uncertainties.

Machine learning under dataset shift

Selected Bs → phi gamma with simulated signal and real-data background. Checked correlations and dataset shifts with control data and hep_ml. Used five folds for feature and hyperparameter selection, with train/test KS diagnostics. Scanned S/sqrt(S+B) using fitted baseline yields and pooled train/test efficiencies; final assessment came from the five-fold results.

Learning TensorFlow and delivering GPU computation

Learned TensorFlow from inherited code; personally ported amplitude models, added efficiency, resolution and bias effects, and validated calculations against mature C++ code at identical sampling points. Resolved discrepancies by aligning variable types; checked simulated observables against real data with KS tests. Set up a shared GPU workstation in half a day, then achieved a GPU run in another half-day. Contributed to testing a collaborator-developed fitter.

For flavour tagging and ECAL clustering, participated in model-construction and training discussions for downstream calibration and validation; did not train these two models.

Learning, delivery & collaboration

- Learning by implementation: extended unfamiliar TensorFlow code with new research models and checked it on generated data; applied CatBoost and Geant4 in other projects.
- Delivery: modernised QCFilter C++/Gaudi code and added a general amplitude interface. Verified against prior simulations and real data; the toolkit was reused and extended by collaborators.
- Collaboration: GitLab development and mutual merge-request review; identified a fitter sign error through mathematical checks. Weekly planning and rapid technical discussions; research presentations at GDR-InF 2022 and FCC/DRD France 2025.

Proposed first assignment: agree the decision and success criteria, check data quality, establish a baseline and deliver a focused validation study with findings and next steps.

Languages & mobility

Chinese: native | English: C1 | French: B1–B2. Long-distance cycling and travel; open to relocation in Europe.

Project references

- ECAL diagnosis and integrated software correction (https://yingrui-hou.github.io/PersonalPage/index.html#work-6)
- Calibrating learned-model outputs (https://yingrui-hou.github.io/PersonalPage/index.html#work-9)
- Machine learning under dataset shift (https://yingrui-hou.github.io/PersonalPage/index.html#work-3)
- Learning TensorFlow and delivering GPU computation (https://yingrui-hou.github.io/PersonalPage/index.html#work-8)